

Ten minutes to your own assistant

I'm a creator, not a coder — that black typing window intimidated me too. The truth: if you can organize files into folders, you can do this. The whole thing is three commands — one installs it, one opens it, and the third is just you asking for what you want. If you can copy and paste, you're qualified.

Claude Code puts Claude on your computer, where it can actually do things — tidy files, write drafts, find anything. You talk to it like a text thread.

YOU NEED

- 1 A paid Claude plan — Pro (\$20 a month), Max, Team, or Enterprise. The free plan doesn't include it.

Not sure which you have? Open claude.ai, tap your initials in the corner, then Settings — your plan is listed right there.

- 2 A Mac or Windows computer.

- 3 Ten minutes.

Keep this open on your phone. Do the steps on your computer.

On a Mac? Your page is next.

On Windows? Skip to page 3.

**If your screen doesn't match a picture, nothing is broken.
Page 7 fixes it. Everyone hits this once.**

Install it on your Mac

- 1 Hold Cmd and tap the space bar. A search box appears.
- 2 Type `terminal` and press Enter. A plain typing window opens.
That window is called Terminal — just a place to type. Every Mac has it.
- 3 Type this line into the window, slowly and exactly — capital letters and all:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

The tall bar `|` is Shift plus the key just above Enter. (Copied it? Cmd+V pastes.)

If you ever see `command not found: claude` — close Terminal fully (Cmd+Q) and open a new window. That's the whole fix.

- 4 Press Enter.
- 5 Text scrolls by for a minute or two. That's the install working.

YOUR SCREEN SHOULD NOW LOOK LIKE THIS



```
sam — zsh — 80x24

sam@MacBook-Air ~ % curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
Downloading Claude Code...
✓ Claude Code installed
sam@MacBook-Air ~ %
```

Yours shows your own name where “sam” is. Close enough counts.

When the scrolling stops and the last line ends with a `%` or `$` sign, you're done.

→ Now go to page 4.

Install it on Windows

- 1 Press the Windows key and type `powershell` — a blue icon appears.
- 2 Press Enter. A window opens where you can type. Blue or black, both are fine.
That window is PowerShell — just a place to type. Look for the line starting with `PS C:\` — that's how you know you're in the right place.
- 3 Type this line into the window, slowly and exactly:

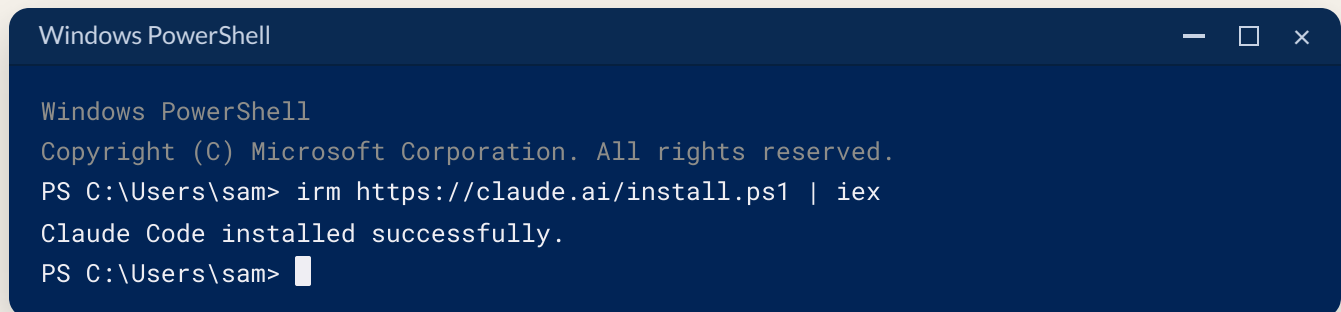
```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

The tall bar `|` is Shift plus the key just above Enter. (Copied it? One right-click pastes.)

See `'irm' is not recognized`? You're in CMD, not PowerShell. Close it, press the Windows key, type `powershell`.

- 4 Press Enter. If Windows pops up a question, click Yes — that's normal.
- 5 Text scrolls by for a minute or two. That's the install working.

YOUR SCREEN SHOULD NOW LOOK LIKE THIS



```
Windows PowerShell
Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.
PS C:\Users\sam> irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
Claude Code installed successfully.
PS C:\Users\sam> 
```

Yours shows your own name where “sam” is — and may be black instead of blue. Close enough counts.

- 6 Close PowerShell fully — click the X — then open a new one the same way. The new window is the one that knows about its new tool.

When your new window opens to a quiet line starting with `PS C:\` and ending in `>`, you're done.

→ Now go to page 4.

Wake it up

- 1 Mac: close Terminal fully (press Cmd+Q), then open it again the same way. Windows: you already did this at the end of page 3 — your fresh window counts.

Closing and reopening is how your computer notices its new tool.

- 2 Type this and press Enter:

```
clause
```

- 3 It asks a few setup questions — colors, sign-in. Press Enter for each one. The suggested answer is always fine.
- 4 Your browser opens so you can sign in. Use your usual Claude account — the same email and password you use on your phone.

When Claude says hello back in the typing window, you're in.

Your first win

Type this exactly and press Enter.

What files are on my Desktop?

If it asks permission, press Enter to say yes. It can look around, but it can't change or delete a thing without asking you first.

Then it lists your real files. It just read your actual computer. That's the whole trick.

HOW TO TALK TO IT

Give it everything at once, like you'd brief a person — not one piece at a time.

× “Help me with my photos.”

Too vague — it has to guess what you want.

✓ “Rename every photo in my Desktop/Products folder based on what's in each image.”

Where, what, and what done looks like — all in one ask.

One good sentence beats ten little ones. Tell it the whole job, then let it work.

Talk instead of type

In the same window, type this and press Enter:

`/voice`

Things that start with / are little built-in buttons you type.

- 1 The first time, your computer asks if Claude can use the microphone — click Allow.
- 2 Hold the space bar and talk, like you're leaving a voice memo. Keep holding — it takes a second to start listening.
Try: "Make a folder on my Desktop called Receipts."
- 3 Let go when you're done. Your words appear in the box — press Enter to send them.

Rather tap once to start and once to send? Type this instead:

`/voice tap`

Voice is free, and the sign-in you already did covers it — talking doesn't use up any of your plan.

Whatever went wrong, do this

First, the good news: nothing is broken. A confusing message can't hurt your computer. There's one move, and it's the same one every time.



↻ New error? Same move.

With the picture, type this sentence and send it. No extra words needed:

I'm setting up Claude Code and got this. What do I do next?

This is what technical people actually do — screenshot the error, paste it, let Claude figure it out. You can never be stuck.

That's it — you're set

From now on, it's three moves:

- 1 Open Terminal (Mac) or PowerShell (Windows).
- 2 Type `claude` and press Enter.
- 3 Ask for what you want, the way you'd ask a person.

Done for the day? Just close the window. Nothing gets lost — tomorrow you type `claude` and it's back.

SOMEDAY, WHEN YOU'RE READY

- It can remember exactly how you like things done.
- It can learn your repeat jobs and run them for you.
- It can plug into your calendar, your email, your files.

ONE LAST PASTE — LET CLAUDE SET YOU UP

Read <https://snowcam000.github.io/claude-code-guide/start.md> and do what it says

Claude reads my setup playbook and walks you through making it yours — your memory file, your folders, your first win. About ten minutes, and it asks before it touches anything. (On a computer? The page you got this from has a one-tap Copy button.)

→ Screenshot Claude's first answer and DM it to me. I read every one.

Go play.